Pollster Analysis — Final Interpretation

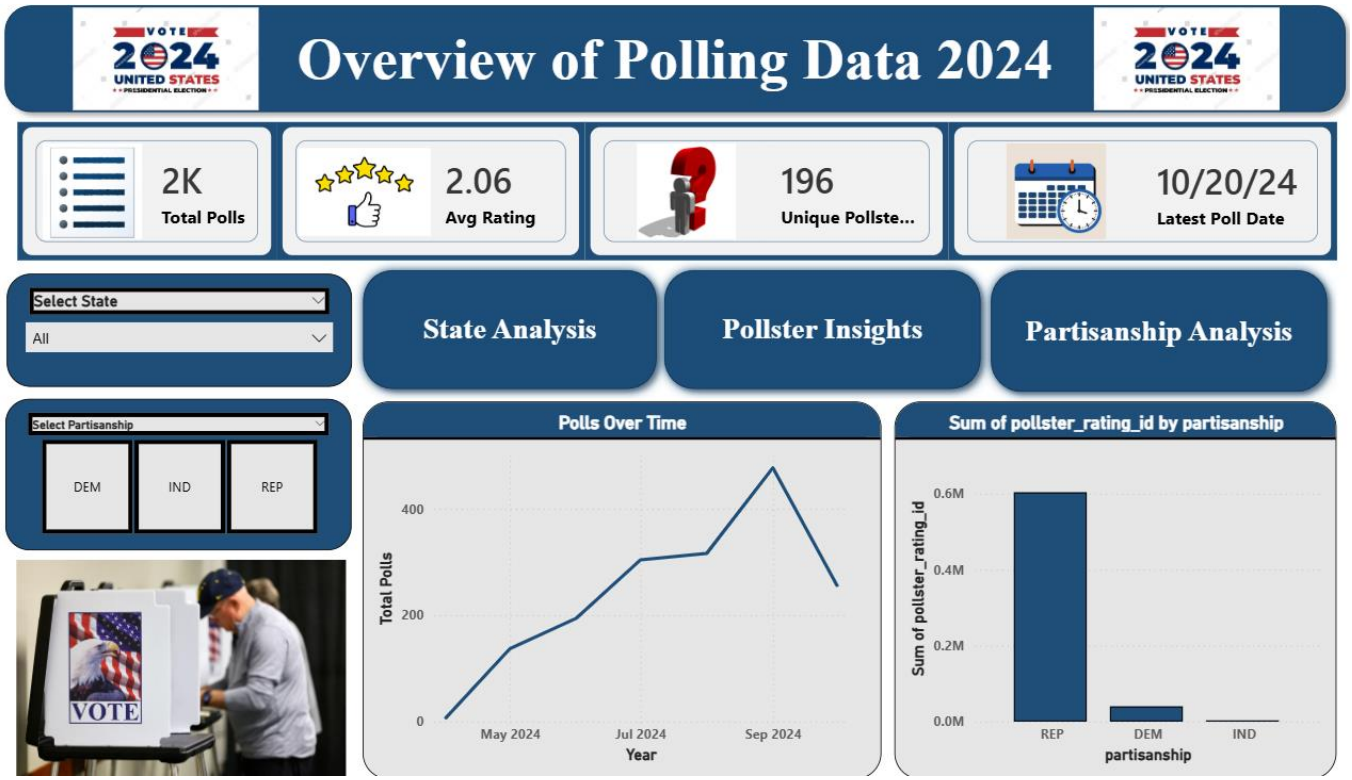
1. Summary

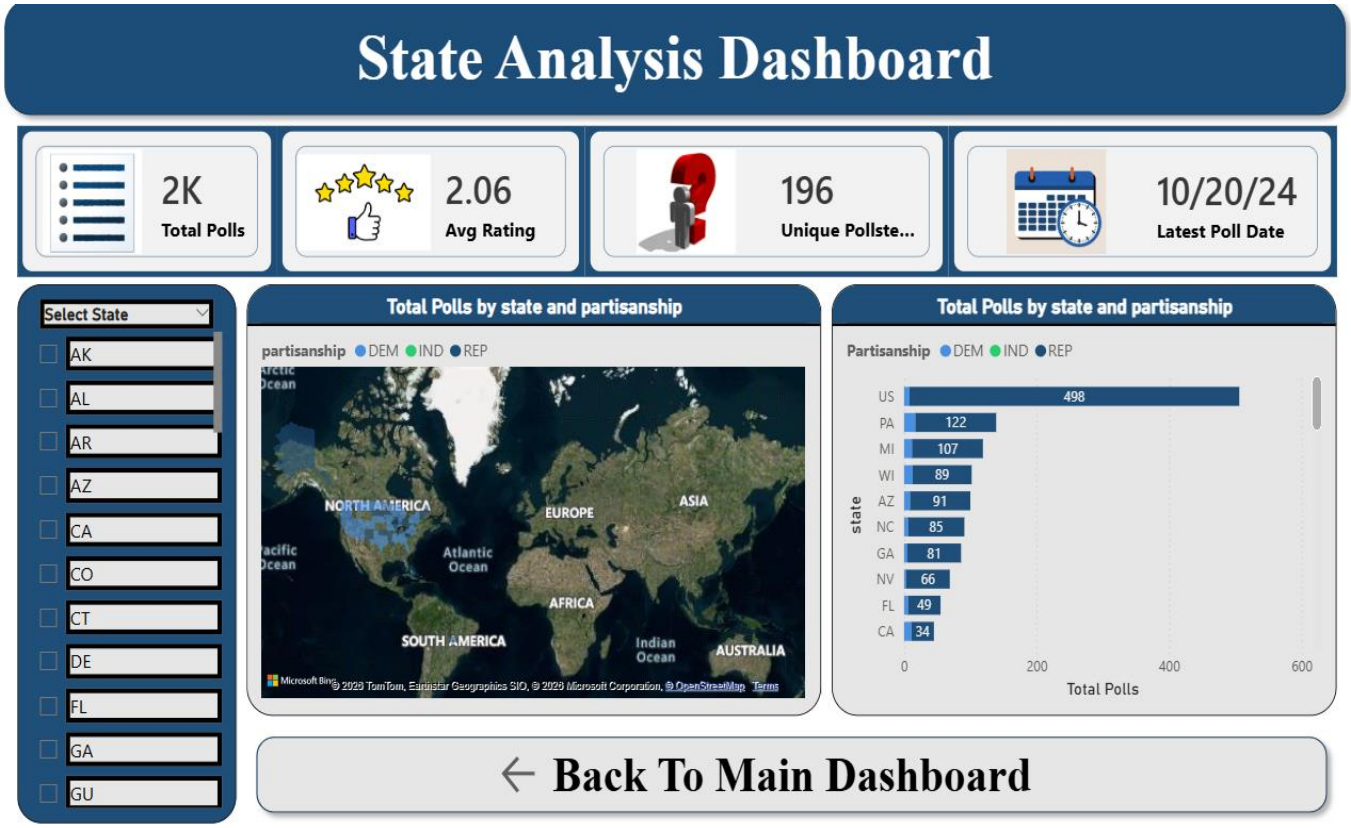
The dashboard highlights the relationship between **pollster credibility, sponsor type, partisanship, and state-level coverage** in the 2024 U.S. elections.
Overall, the analysis indicates that **Republican pollsters dominate in frequency**, while **Democratic pollsters score slightly higher in average ratings**. Independent pollsters are fewer but provide moderate balance.
Polling activity is concentrated in **battleground states (PA, WI, MI, GA)**, and sponsor type (media/university vs partisan) plays a major role in credibility.

Polling bias is not random; it is driven by a combination of **partisanship, sponsorship, and geographic focus**, rather than a single isolated factor.

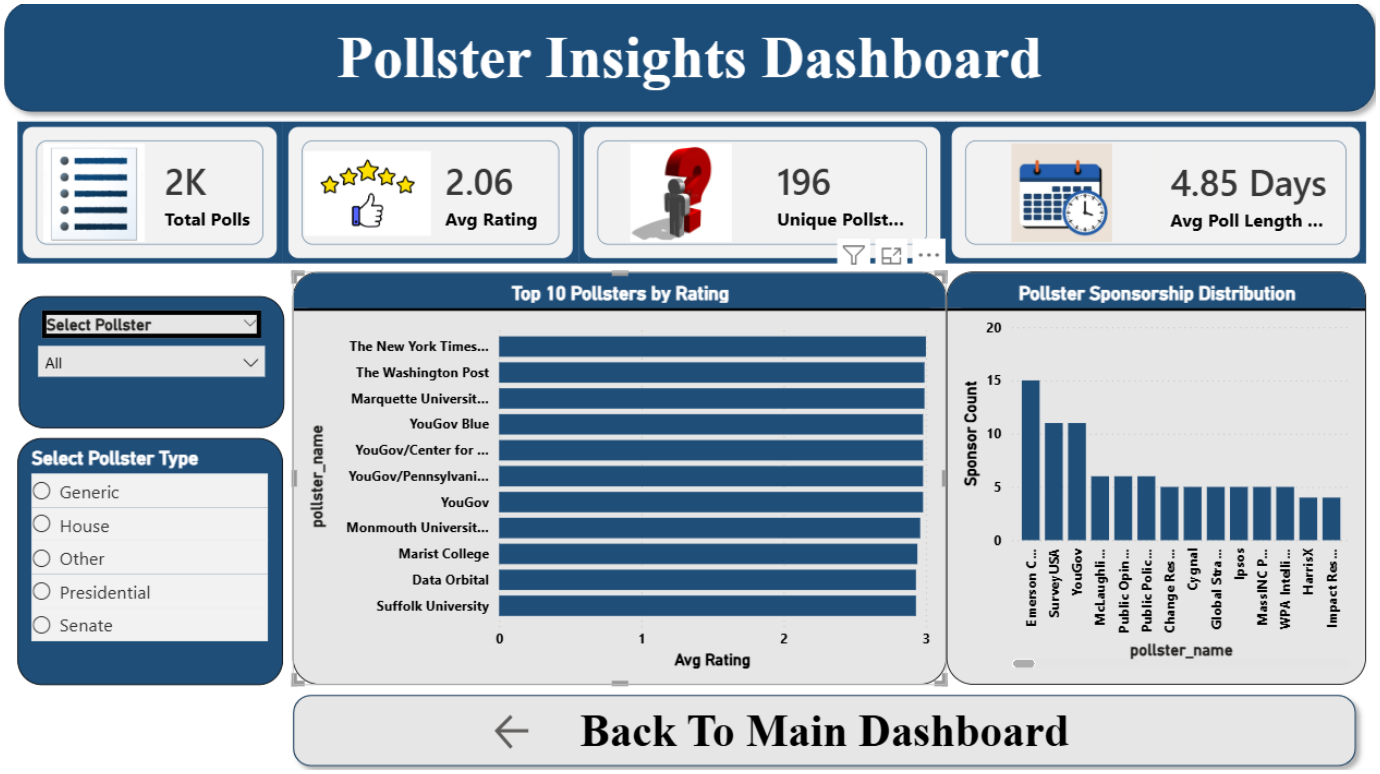
2. Dashboard

The Power BI dashboard consists of three main pages:

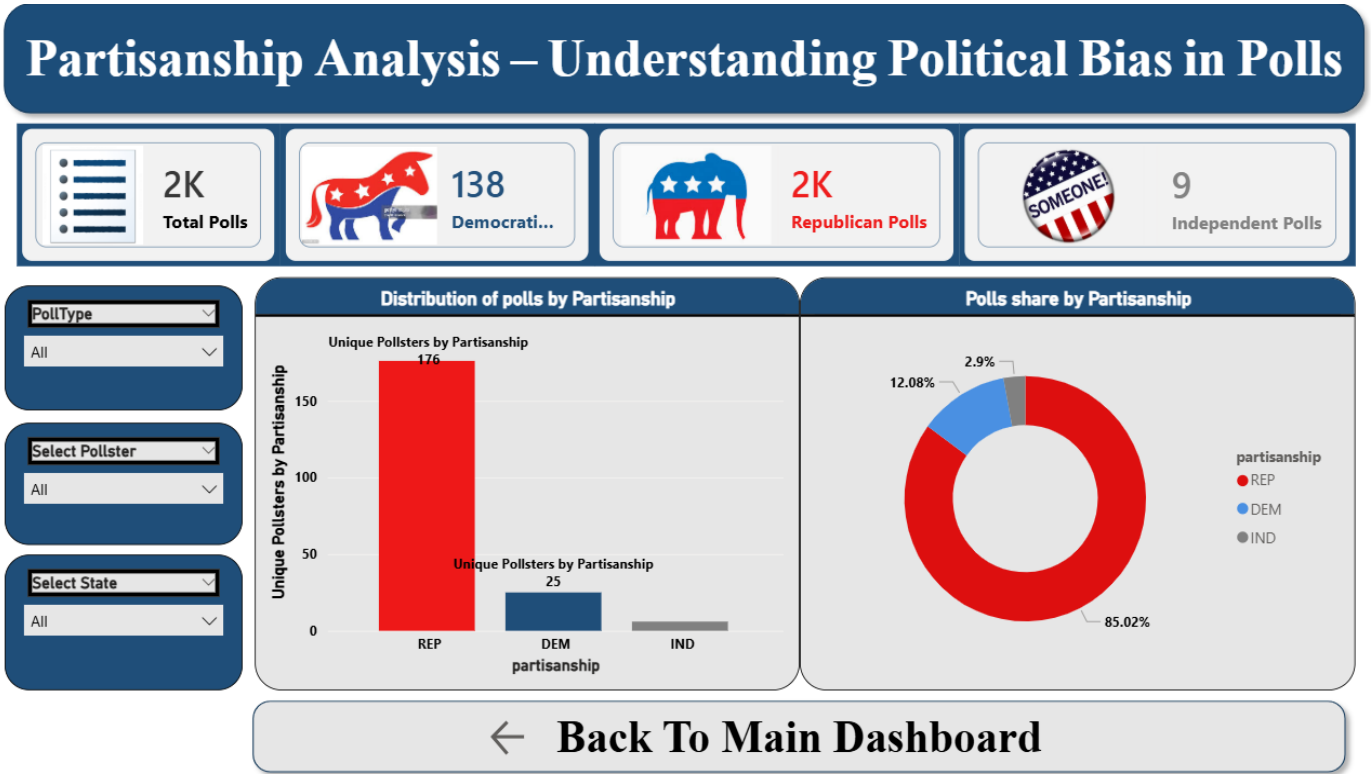




- **State Analysis Dashboard**
  - Total polls by state and partisanship (REP, DEM, IND).
  - Battleground states highlighted (PA, MI, WI, GA).
  - Interactive slicers for state selection, enabling dynamic filtering.
  - Map visualization showing geographic distribution of polls by credibility rating.
  - Bar chart comparing poll counts and ratings across states.
  - Navigation buttons for seamless movement between dashboard pages.



- **Pollster Insights Dashboard**
  - Top 10 pollsters by rating.
  - Sponsorship distribution (media, PAC, university).
  - Average poll length and credibility scores.
  - Scatter plot comparing poll length vs error margin, color-coded by partisanship.
  - Table of recent polls with date, topic, sample size, and result.
  - Drill-down filters for pollster type and partisanship alignment.



- **Partisanship Analysis Dashboard**
  - Distribution of polls by political alignment (Republican, Democrat, Independent).
  - Pie chart showing share of polls across partisan groups.
  - Box plot comparing pollster credibility ratings by partisanship.
  - Interactive slicers for filtering by poll type, state, and pollster name.
  - KPI cards summarizing total polls, average ratings, and partisan breakdown.
  - Insight text highlighting trends (e.g., Democratic pollsters showing slightly higher ratings).

3. Key Insights

Partisanship Distribution:

- **Republican pollsters dominate in frequency** (majority of polls).
- **Democratic pollsters score slightly higher in average credibility ratings.**
- **Independent pollsters are underrepresented** (only ~9 polls).

Insight: Frequency dominance belongs to Republicans, but credibility leadership leans toward Democrats.

Sponsor Influence:

- Media and university-backed polls consistently achieve **higher ratings**.
- Partisan-sponsored polls often score **lower credibility**.

Insight: Sponsor type is a critical driver of poll reliability.

State-Level Coverage:

- Battleground states (PA, WI, MI, GA) attract **more polling activity**.
- National-level polls dominate overall count, but state-level distribution reveals **imbalances**.

Insight: Polling coverage is concentrated in key battlegrounds, potentially skewing national interpretation.

Pollster Insights:

- **Top pollsters** include YouGov, Marist College, Monmouth University, Emerson College, and SurveyUSA.
- Average poll length is ~4.85 days.
- Ratings vary significantly across pollsters, reflecting sponsor influence.

Insight: Certain pollsters consistently lead in credibility, making them more reliable for election analysis.

4. Business Recommendations

- **Prioritize high-rated pollsters** (media/university-backed) for credible insights.
- **Treat partisan-sponsored polls with caution**, as they show lower ratings.
- **Balance state-level coverage** by encouraging polling beyond battleground states.
- **Standardize pollster evaluation methods** to reduce missing data and improve comparability.

5. Final Story

The Pollster Analysis dashboard demonstrates that **polling credibility is shaped by partisanship, sponsorship, and geography**.
Republican pollsters dominate in count, but Democratic pollsters edge higher in ratings.
Independent pollsters remain few but provide balance.
Sponsor type strongly influences credibility, with media/university polls outperforming partisan-sponsored polls.
State-level analysis reveals concentration in battlegrounds, highlighting the need for balanced coverage.

One-line summary:
Polling credibility in 2024 is driven by **partisanship and sponsor type**, with Republicans dominating in frequency, Democrats leading in ratings, and battleground states receiving disproportionate coverage.